

Settings

Realistically carved coral petals



Coral ring | For the centrepiece of this gold ring, angelskin coral was carved into rose blossom petals. The flushes of colour mimic the tints of a real rose.

Delicately radiating petals



Coral set earrings | A specimen of deep red coral has been delicately carved to create matching rose shapes for these small stud earrings.

Teardrop cabochon



Maple-leaf pin | This gold-plated pin is set with oval and teardrop-shaped coral cabochons of differing sizes slotted within the serrated edges of the "leaf".

Intricately carved headpiece



Coral carving | Coral is associated with the safeguarding of children, and this miniature carving may have been a gift intended to bring protection to the wearer.

In the classical world, coral was worn as an amulet to protect against the evil eye

Gold branch



Snake divided into segments

Snake brooch | Designed as a stepped coral snake, the carving of this late 19th-century comprises 30 sections, intertwined with a scrolling branch.

Emerald eye

Fanned-out coral wings



Diamonds set in gold

Hummingbird brooch | This hummingbird, with coral wings and tail outstretched in flight, was produced c.1975 by the jewellers Kutchinsky. It also incorporates diamonds, gold, mother-of-pearl, and emerald.

Blood of the Gorgon

Gory beginnings

In Greek mythology, the hero Perseus beheaded Medusa, the Gorgon who turned people to stone by looking at them. Perseus then used Medusa's severed head to petrify a sea monster, Cetus – Medusa's gaze in death was still lethal. Afterwards, he set the head down on a riverbank where the blood ran into the water, transforming seaweed into red coral. *Gorgeia* – after Gorgon – is the Greek word for coral.



Looks can kill This coral carving, from the 2nd or 1st century BCE, Bactria (in present-day Afghanistan and Tajikistan), is of Medusa.